

Table 3. Stage Grouping Definition

Applied to clinical_unified_202604172056.csv column cancer_stage_group.

Group	AJCC / FIGO Stage Included	Interpretation
Early	Stage I, IA, IA1, IA2, IB, IIA, IIB	Localized / regional disease, potentially curative resection.
Advanced	Stage IIIA, IIIB, IIIC, IVA, IVB	Locally advanced or distant metastatic disease; systemic therapy indicated.
Unknown	TX / NX / MX present, or stage field blank	Insufficient staging data; excluded from Early vs Advanced comparison.

Pre-assignment rules (from staging_mapping_log.txt, AJCC 8th ed.)

Pancreatic (PAC)	T1 N0 M0 → IA; T2 N0 M0 → IB; T3 N0 M0 → IIA; T _{≤3} N1 M0 → IIB; T4 <i>or</i> N2 → III; M1 → IV.	T4 or N2 = Stage III; any M1 = Stage IV.
Colorectal (CRC)	TNM mapped via AJCC 8th. CRC 271–300 labeled Advanced (user-assigned).	1–270 Early, 271–300 Advanced.
Prostate (PRC)	pT2 N0 M0 / cT _{≤2} as Early; pT3a+/N1+ as Advanced; M1 → IV.	PSA not used here.
Lung (LC)	cancer_stage normalized (“IA1”, “stage 1A” → IA, etc.); IA/IB/IIA/IIB → Early;	Original field contained formatting variations.

Reference: AJCC Cancer Staging Manual, 8th Edition; FIGO 2014 for ovarian.